

Review

On 28 January 2026, Minister for Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry, the Hon Julie Collins launched the independent review of the Horticulture Code of Conduct (Code). The review will be undertaken by Mr. Chris Leptos AO.

Mr Leptos has been consulting with growers, traders and other parts of the horticulture supply chain. A [Have Your Say page](#) was open from 28 January 2026 through to 20 March 2026.

Mr Leptos is due to provide a report to government by mid-2026.

Background

The Horticulture Code of Conduct (Horticulture Code) is a mandatory industry code under section 51AE of the Competition and Consumer Act 2010. The Code regulates trade between growers and traders of horticulture produce to ensure transparency and clarity of transactions.

The [Code](#) also provides a process for resolving disputes that occur under the Code, including under horticulture produce agreements. Under the Horticulture Code, if a dispute occurs, growers and traders may use any resolution procedure they choose. However, should one of the parties initiate the dispute resolution procedure set out in the Horticulture Code, it must be followed by both parties.

The Australian Small Business and Family Enterprise Ombudsman (ASBFEO) is responsible for supporting dispute resolution under the Horticulture Code. Further information about the ASBFEO and dispute resolution can be found at the [ASBFEO](#) website, by emailing info@asbfeo.gov.au or calling 1300 650 460.

The Horticulture Code is enforced by the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC). Guidance materials for growers and traders on the Horticulture Code is available at the [ACCC](#) website.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/hort-policy/code-of-conduct>